Victoire Gonzalvez

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Selected Works 2025–2023

Portfolio 2026

Portrait by Shanna Warocquier, 2025

Victoire Gonzalvez (b. 1997) is an artist and author based in Paris, working across sculpture, installation, writing, and performance.

Her practice examines norms and dispositifs whose uses and assumed meanings are no longer questioned, and which, through repetition, generate effects of estrangement or dysfunction. Through simulated surfaces and architectural fragments integrated into scenographic environments, she explores how these settings shape perception, behavior, and the collective narratives they produce, paying particular attention to what circulates or overflows within bodies and spaces, sometimes to the point of resistance. She often develops her own material and patination processes, conceived as tools for constructing decor.

Trained at the École nationale supérieure des Arts Décoratifs in Paris and introduced to prosthetics techniques at Cinecittà, she has developed a sustained interest in replicas, surfaces, and fabricated bodies, at the point where imitation becomes convincing or begins to fracture.

Between 2021 and 2023, she was a resident of the Weissenhof Program at the Kunstakademie Stuttgart. Her work has been presented at Magasins Généraux (Pantin), Galerie Mansart (Paris), Villa Merkel (Stuttgart), Fondation Thalie (Brussels), and Galerie Jean Collet (Vitry-sur-Seine).

Since 2022, she has been pursuing a long-term research project in La Jonquera, a border town between France and Spain, focusing on transit architectures and visual dispositifs related to desire and circulation.

Villa Belleville

Artist residency

2025

At Villa Belleville, I developed a project combining fiction, materials, and installation. Written at the beginning of the residency, La Casa del Turrón, a situated narrative set in Els Limits (Girona, Spain), serves as the project's starting point. The text opens an exploration of surface.

The experiments take the form of wall-mounted panels intended to recreate a fictional club space, produced through reappropriated tapestry techniques. The project extends into a filmed work, which explores representations of eroticism through texts written around the experience of being overwhelmed, which become the material of the film itself.

July 2025 – January 2026

Banquette, leather, grease, pigment, foam, wood, 80 × 65 × 20 cm

Panneau, leather, grease, pigment, foam, wood, 120 × 80 × 15 cm

Detail of the work Accoudoir

Silkscreen on leather using milk powder

During the residency, I developed a research project focused on leather and patination, experimenting with mixtures of grease, milk, and pigments. By working on human trace through scanning and transfer techniques, I further develop a central gesture in my practice: the casting of the body.

Scanning human traces on transparent tracing paper and research into varnished tissue paper

Coco Sour

Solo exhibition, Galerie Jean Collet, Vitry-sur-Seine

Presented at Galerie Jean Collet, in the former public baths of Vitry-sur-Seine, Coco Sour proposed a tension between hygiene and intimacy through a set of sculptures and installations incorporating multiple bodily imprints: knee pads, latex gloves, and wooden casts molded from the bodies of participants involved in the project.

Inspired by the Magdalen laundries, known as the Maggies, where labor, hygiene, and moral surveillance were intertwined, the exhibition examined how the aesthetics of hygiene operate as a dispositif of control, shaping bodies and

Février 2025 – Avril 2025

Pied 4/4, machined wood, lacquer paint, varnish, 25 × 38 × 29 cm

Hawaï Saint-Suaire, printed terry towel, bleach, fist gel, PVC, Plexiglas, 205 × 155 × 20 cm

Coco Sour

Genouillères, vegetable-tanned leather, hand-painted leather, lace, 20 × 37 × 15 cm

Bassin 4/4, machined wood, lacquer paint, varnish, 36 × 42 × 30 cm

Performance, Espace à salir, presented with four performers, March 16, 2025

At the halfway point of the three-month exhibition, the performance Espace à salir, conceived with Salomé Kalonji, Constance Mathys, Unfarrowed Soilage, and Inès Yahiaoui, interrupted the exhibition's temporal flow: a day-long action that divided the presentation into two distinct states, before and after. This intervention altered the reading of the works, revealing signs of use, wear, and the site's gradual transformation.

Stucco and Cream

Research residency, Fondation Thalie, Brussels

2024

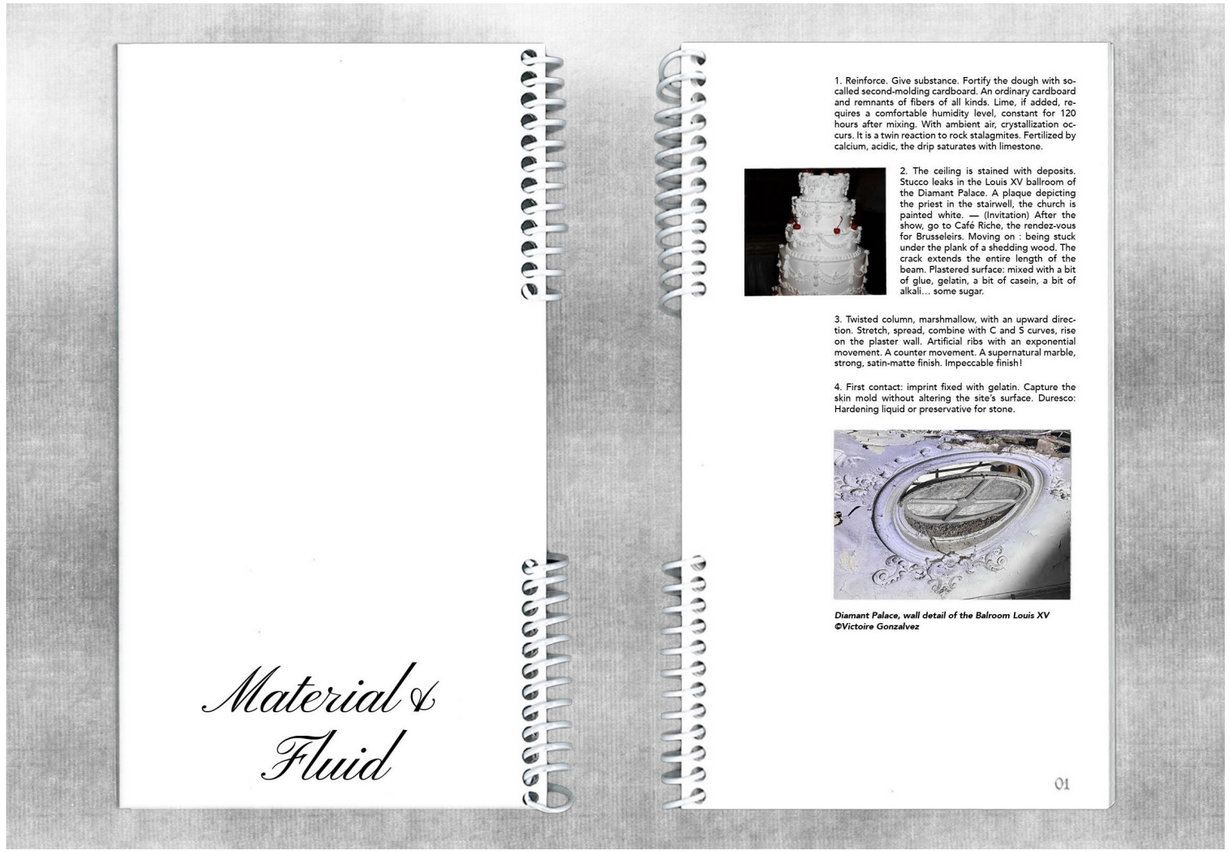
At Fondation Thalie, I conducted a research project on carton-pierre, a material of imitation and counterfeiting developed in nineteenth-century Brussels. By consulting city archives and restoration workshops, I developed my own recipe, drawing on historical formulas and attentive to the gendered and domestic dimensions of decorative know-how.

The project brings together fictional writing and material research, creating a dialogue between the substance of decor and that of the body. Le Stuc et la Crème emerged from this process: a text and a set of experiments in which paste, worked like a sweet stucco, shifts decor toward more intimate registers. This displacement engages a critical reappropriation of the language of the fake and the feminine, through the edible and a direct relation to the body.

May 2024 – August 2024

Archival image, detail of the ceiling of the Hôtel de Ville de Liège, 1718–1719

Images extracted from an interview on the fabrication process, conducted in the studio during the residency



Experimental writing project combining poetry and material research.
Conceived at Fondation Thalie, May–July 2024. Self-published edition, 25 copies, 22 × 12 × 1.5 cm

Test board of different carton-pierre recipes

Translating Bodies

Installation, exhibition Area of Effect, Villa Merkel, Stuttgart

Presented in the exhibition Area of Effect, the final presentation of the Weissenhof research program at the Akademie der Bildenden Künste Stuttgart, Translating Bodies is a participatory installation conceived in dialogue with the performance group Discotheca Flaming Star.

The work reenacts gestures of bodily preparation prior to entering an intimate space. Visitors are invited to use embroidered hotel towels before entering a room where a footbath is made available.

A process of transfer unfolds between the wardrobe and the laundry bin, transforming individual care into a collective protocol. Through this shift, the installation engages the circulation of the body, its translation into space, and the

November 2023

Detail on the back of the work Closet

Closet, lacquered wood, glass, silver leaf, stack of embroidered towels, 197 × 110 × 53 cm

Detail of the laundry bin made available to the public in the second room of the installation

Footbath, HoMedics footbath, platform, polyester, chlorine, 215 × 100 × 30 cm

Detail of the work during activation

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thank you !